

Cold email template pack

FREE TEMPLATE

The Two C's: a compliment and a connection. One ask. Under 120 words.

1. Same school. Alumni from your school. Your highest reply rate, so start here.

Subject: [School] freshman: quick question about your path into [field]

Hi [First name],

I saw you went from [school] to [firm], and your move from [previous role] into [current role] caught my eye. [One specific detail from their profile or work.]

I'm a freshman studying [major] and trying to learn how people actually break into [field]. Would you be open to a short call in the next couple of weeks? Happy to work around your schedule.

Thank you,
[Your name]
[School] · [LinkedIn URL]

2. Shared background. Same hometown, same high school, same first job, same first-gen path.

Subject: From [hometown] to [role]: a question

Hi [First name],

I noticed you're also from [hometown] (I went to [high school]). Seeing someone from home working in [field] at [firm] made me want to reach out.

I'm a freshman at [school] exploring [field]. Would you have 20 minutes for a quick call sometime soon? I'd love to hear how you got started.

Best,
[Your name]
[LinkedIn URL]

3. Something they made. They wrote a post, gave a talk, were quoted, or worked on something public.

Subject: Your post on [topic]

Hi [First name],

I read your post on [topic], especially the point about [specific point]. It changed how I think about [related idea].

I'm a freshman at [school] interested in [field], and I'd love to ask you a couple of questions about your work at [firm]. Would you be open to a short call in the next two weeks?

Thanks,
[Your name]
[LinkedIn URL]

4. Local or small firm. Local firms, boutiques, and small teams where a student reaching out is rare.

Subject: Local student with a question about [firm]

Hi [First name],

I'm a freshman at [school] and I've been reading about [firm]'s work with [type of client / recent project]. It's rare to find a firm doing [specific thing] right here in [your area].

I'm trying to learn how people get started in [field]. Would you be open to a quick call? I'm local and happy to meet for coffee if that's easier.

Thank you,
[Your name]
[LinkedIn URL]

5. Startup founder. Founders and early employees. Shorter, more direct, lead with what you noticed.

Subject: [Company]'s [feature / launch]

Hi [First name],

I've been using / following [company] since [specific thing], and [one sentence on what impressed you].

I'm a freshman at [school] who wants to learn how early-stage companies work. Would you be open to a 15-20 minute call? If there's ever a small project I could help with, I'd love to hear about it too.

[Your name]
[LinkedIn URL]

At most 4 follow-ups. Weekly in November and December (peak season); biweekly to monthly off-peak.

Follow-up sequence

STEP	PEAK (NOV-DEC)	OFF-PEAK	WHAT TO SEND
Follow-up 1	Day 7	Day 14	Hi [First name], just bumping this up in case it got buried. Would love 20 minutes whenever works. Thank you!
Follow-up 2	Day 14	Day 28	Hi [First name], I know this time of year is busy. I'm still very interested in hearing about your path at [firm]. Even a short call would help a lot.
Follow-up 3	Day 21	Day 45	Hi [First name], I've been [one real update: reading about X / started Y]. It made me want to ask you about [specific question] even more. Any chance for a quick call?
Follow-up 4 (last)	Day 28	Day 75	Hi [First name], I'll leave it here so I'm not crowding your inbox. If a call ever makes sense down the road, I'd be grateful. Thanks for reading.